

The **wood anemone** is one of the first flowers to emerge in early spring. **Squill** and **wild garlic** soon follow, shooting up from underground bulbs and soaking up sunlight with their long leaves before the trees above burst into leaf. These plants are known as “spring ephemerals” because they spend just a few weeks in bloom before dying back, ready for next spring. The **large-flowered**

trillium survives like this for up to 70 years. Enclosed by a thick green canopy of leaves, the forest floor is dark, cool, and damp throughout the summer, ideal conditions for **sword ferns** and **mosses** to grow. In autumn the leaves fall from the trees, insulating the earth in the colder months and building up a thick layer of matter to enrich the soil.



Sword fern

Each pinna (leaflet) has a lobe that sticks up at its base, giving it the shape of a sword hilt.



Fawn lily

Six tepals grow around the anthers. The tepals curl back toward the stalk to advertise the flower to pollinators.

Large-flowered trillium

A striped bract surrounds and covers each flower spike.



Jack-in-the-pulpit

This plant is **poisonous** but, if cooked properly, its root can be made into **bread**.

The three-petaled flowers first appear when this plant is 7–10 years old.



Pincushion moss

Dense clumps grow slowly but can reach 3 ft (1 m) wide. Each leaf is no more than 1/3 in (9 mm) long.

